



The Home Buyers Checklist

Ready to buy your home?



Buying a new house is one of the biggest investments that a person can make in their life. This can be extremely stressful, but it doesn't have to be.

This checklist will help you to be in control every step of the way and feel confident in the process.

Here are the steps:

- **Building a Foundation**
- **The Financials**
- **Insuring Your Home**
- **Finding Your New Home**
- **The Home Stretch**

BUILDING A FOUNDATION

STEP 1: FIND A REALTOR

- ☐ Interview a few real estate brokers and see if their personality matches your needs/wants. You want to “click”!
- ☐ Qualifications your real estate brokers should have:
 - ☐ Local market knowledge
 - ☐ Good reviews or testimonials
 - ☐ Financial Knowledge - they can walk you through the numbers!
 - ☐ Find an agent who works full time in the industry and has a track record.
 - ☐ Great time management and communication skills:
 - ☐ Did they show up on time & prepared?
 - ☐ Do they communicate with you in a way that you understand and feel comfortable?

STEP 2: KNOW YOUR FINANCIALS

- ☐ Maintain great credit
- ☐ Pay off as much debt as you can before proceeding
- ☐ Compile and save any important financial documents
 - ☐ 2 months worth of pay stubs & bank statements
 - ☐ 2 years of tax returns & W-2's (if applicable)

STEP 3: FIND A LENDER

- ☐ Compare different lenders to understand the benefits and advantages of working with each. Something as simple as a lower rate or term can save you thousands of dollars over the life of the loan.
- ☐ Make sure to tell EACH LENDER not to pull your credit until you're fully committed to working with one.
- ☐ If your credit isn't where you want it to be, work on creating a plan with your chosen lender
- ☐ Your agent may also be able to help you find someone trustworthy that they have worked with before.



THE FINANCIALS

STEP 4: ESTABLISH A BUDGET

- ☐ Saving up 20% of a home's purchase price as a down payment is suggested, but often hard to do in high-priced markets
- ☐ If saving up 20% isn't feasible, work with your lender to create the best plan for your needs

Remember that just because you're approved for a certain amount doesn't mean that you have to spend that amount. Work with your lender and agent to establish a price point and monthly payment that you will be comfortable with.

STEP 5: GET PRE-APPROVED FOR A MORTGAGE

- ☐ Ask the lender if you qualify for any special loans
- ☐ Get Pre-Approved; this gives you, your agent, and the lender an estimate of how much you can afford based off of your credit score and past financial documents
- ☐ Work with your lender and real estate agent to determine if your file should be underwritten before submitting any offers. This will help to avoid any potential disappointments or delays during the transaction



FINDING YOUR NEW HOME

STEP 6: THE FUN PART

- ☐ Meet with your chosen real estate agent to discuss your home buying wish list.
 - ☐ Must haves: bed/bath number, garage, etc.
 - ☐ Nice to have: pool, jacuzzi, smart home capabilities, etc.
 - ☐ Things to avoid: pools, busy streets, etc.
- ☐ Bring along your pre-approval and lender contact information so you can discuss budget and have your real estate broker connect with your chosen lender.
- ☐ Determine different neighborhoods you might want to live in.

STEP 7: FIND A HOME

- ☐ Keep your "Must Haves" Checklist in mind.
- ☐ Keep a journal or guide of the different houses you're interested in.
- ☐ Stay within your price range!
- ☐ Bring a snack, water, and shoes that are easy to slip on and off
- ☐ Provide your real estate broker with ANY feedback regarding the properties that you view. Both positive and negative feedback can be very helpful for a real estate broker to find exactly what you want

STEP 8: MAKE AN OFFER

- ☐ Work with your real estate broker to establish a strategy to get the most from your offer and have the best chance of it getting accepted.
- ☐ Sign the offer and any additional documents!



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INSURING YOUR HOME

STEP 9: DO YOUR DUE DILIGENCE

- ☐ Find a reputable and thorough home inspector, if you need suggestions ask your real estate broker.
 - ☐ A good home inspector will help to ensure that you don't end up in a "money pit," for example, a property with lots of electricity, plumbing or foundation issues.
 - ☐ An inspector will also report any issues found with the home that will allow you to ask for repairs during negotiations.
- ☐ If work is needed to be done on the property, strategize with your real estate broker to submit a request for repairs or offer adjustment.
- ☐ Review disclosures and paperwork with your agent.
- ☐ If you will be making any additions or construction to the property, such as adding a pool or a guest house, check with the city building department to ensure zoning allows for those upgrades.

STEP 10: ARRANGE FOR HOMEOWNER'S INSURANCE

- ☐ Search for a homeowner's insurance policy with great coverage at a reasonable cost. Ask your lender for suggestions if necessary.





THE HOME STRETCH

STEP 11: FINALIZE FINANCING WITH YOUR LENDER

- ☐ The lender will order an appraisal on the home to verify that the market value supports the purchase price.
- ☐ Double check that your interest rates and mortgage payments are what you agreed upon.

STEP 12: FINAL WALKTHROUGH OF THE HOME

- ☐ Go through the house with your real estate broker to double check everything you agreed upon in your offer is present.
Ensure that any repairs that were agreed upon in the transaction were completed.
- ☐ If repairs are difficult to visually inspect, call back your home inspector or a specialist to ensure the repairs were completed correctly.
- ☐ Turn on all lights and appliances to make sure that they still are in good working order.

STEP 13: CLOSING THE DEAL

- ☐ Bring everything you might need:
 - ☐ Form of identification
 - ☐ Any additional payment you may need
 - ☐ Sign the mortgage documents!

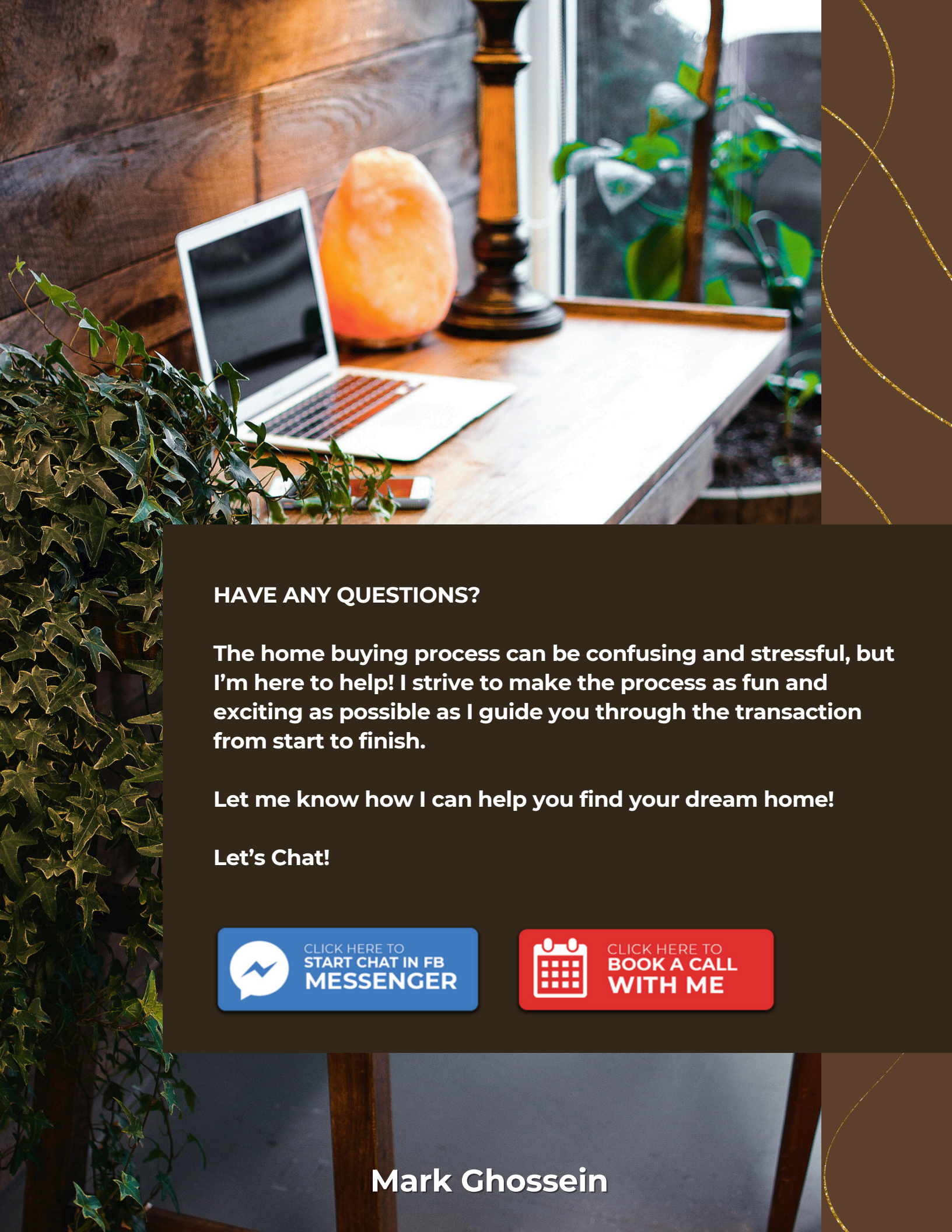
STEP 14: MOVE IN!

- ☐ Wait for your lawyer to contact you. Once the deal has closed they will call you to pick up the keys.
- ☐ Celebrate! You now own your new home!



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HAVE ANY QUESTIONS?

The home buying process can be confusing and stressful, but I'm here to help! I strive to make the process as fun and exciting as possible as I guide you through the transaction from start to finish.

Let me know how I can help you find your dream home!

Let's Chat!



Mark Ghossein